



CURRICULUM

MASSAGE THERAPY PROGRAM

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Introduction to East-West College Massage Therapy Program

The Massage Therapy profession requires that the therapist uphold high ethical standards and practices. Therapeutic massage requires close contact with clients and students in this program are expected to demonstrate professionalism and comply with the ethical standards of the profession during their treatment of clients.

The East-West College of Business and Technology's massage therapy curriculum is developed by Professional experts to match changing job market needs and provide you the hands-on training and support to ensure your successful completion.

Students at East-West College will learn the technical skills that will give you an advantage in your career, along with critical communication and business skills you'll need to succeed in today's competitive environment. It's a powerful combination that is rare in higher education, and one that employers expect.



Year 1

Course Title: Introduction to Massage Therapy

Duration: 40 Hours

In this course students will be provided with basic manual application of massage therapy for general relaxation and also an overview of Physiological and Psychological effects and benefits of massage therapy. They will learn patient handling, table set up and draping techniques as they develop their palpation and tactile skills. Students will also learn history of massage therapy and its modernization over the years.

Course Title: Massage Theory and Practice

Duration: 60 Hours

This course is designed to introduce the students to basic concepts of massage therapy and medical terminology used in documentation and communication among professionals. Students will also learn how to correlate and understand relevant layman's terms during the course. Students will have the opportunity to learn advantages and limits of the massage therapy. During the course students would be encouraged to use critical thinking while applying the concepts of massage.

Course: Principles and Sequence of Massage

Duration: 40 Hours

In this course students will learn how to synchronize their own rhythm and pressure to what is more relaxing and acceptable to the client. During the course students will have the opportunity to acquire the pertinent knowledge and skills.

Course: Anatomy and Physiology I

Duration: 100 Hours

This course provides students with an introduction to the human body, with a brief overview of the introductory chemistry, cellular biology, histology, and fundamental principles of systemic anatomy and physiology as they pertain to homeostasis. The course is designed to introduce to students ti basic terminology, concepts and overview of structure and function of the body.



Course; Anatomy and Physiology II

Duration: 80 Hours

This is the second course in the AP series and builds the foundations of Anatomy and Physiology I. A systemic approach is taken from this point forward, beginning with the cardiovascular system.

Students will learn the anatomical and physiology properties of the cardiovascular and pulmonary systems including blood, the heart, lungs and blood vessels in great depth, as well as discuss its relation to massage therapy. The lymphatic system and immune system will be described and introduced as well. In preparation for SA 001/002 and NAP 001 in their second year.

Course: Massage Therapy I

Duration: 80 Hours

During this course students will be provided with knowledge and skills to apply safe and effective therapeutic massage techniques.

Course: Massage Therapy II:

Duration: 80 Hours

During this course students will be provided with knowledge and skills to provide safe and effective techniques for athletes and clients involved in various sports activities.

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Course: Systemic Anatomy I

Duration: 100 Hours

This is the first of the two Systemic Anatomy courses in the final year of study. In this course, students will acquire knowledge of the respiratory, digestive and urinary systems. Each system will be described in detail, and their relation to massage therapy. Pathologies will be touched on for each system in preparation for ACTP 002 later in the year.

Course: Osteology

Duration: 60 Hours

This is an introductory course to the anatomy of the human skeletal system and is part one of the Osteology and Myology series. Students will be introduced to bone formation, growth and the organization of bones of the human body. Joint biomechanics will be discussed. This course is a prerequisite to Myology 1 and all second-year courses.

Course: Myology and Palpation

Duration: 60 Hours

This course will assist students in acquiring the fundamental knowledge of the human muscle in system. Classification of types of muscle, muscle fiber direction and importance of muscle will be covered in depth. General neurology will be discussed in relation to the musculoskeletal system. Skills to palpate superficial and deep structures of the human body will be gained.



Course: Therapeutic Exercise 1

Duration: 60 Hours

This course will assist students in acquiring the fundamental knowledge and skills in integrating therapeutic exercise into massage therapy practice. Students will specifically learn foundational concepts and the applied science of exercise and techniques as therapeutic intervention. During the training the students will use different therapeutic techniques appropriate for different conditions.

Course: Clinical Laboratory 1

Duration: 25 Hours

In this course students will have an opportunity to practice safe and nurturing touch on each other and various clients. Students will develop foundational skills that will be utilized in a future clinical setting. The process of giving and receiving massage will be under direct supervision of the massage instructor. This will enable the students to apply the knowledge and skills learned so far in professional and ethical manner.

Course: Relaxation Massage Therapy

Duration: 60 Hours

This course will enable students to demonstrate the classical strokes and relaxation techniques. Emphasis will be placed on touch, proper body mechanics and palpation skills. Students will be able to successfully perform a complete full body relaxation massage by the end of this course.

Course: Ethics and Communication

Duration: 50 Hours

In this course students will be introduced to fundamental concepts of ethics, morals, self-examination and professionalism. Students will be provided with opportunity to understand the ethical values as a massage therapist as expected from them in Canadian multi-cultural society. The course will also provide the students with current and relevant laws pertaining to massage therapists in Alberta.

Course: Safety and Sanitary Practices

Duration: 40 Hours

In this course students will be introduced to fundamental and mandatory requirements for safety and sanitary



practices in a massage clinic. Students will be provided with knowledge and skills to understand and manage sanitation and safety of client, therapist, massage equipment, massage furniture and the environment. They will have the opportunity to understand the federal and provincial safety bylaws

Course: Service Based Accounting

Duration: 25 Hours

An overview of basic accounting concepts for service-based businesses. Includes theoretical concepts and exposure to an integrated accounting software package for all aspects of the accounting cycle.

Course: Clinical Practicum/Internship I

Duration: 180 Hours

In this course students will be placed in a clinic setting where they gain experience working on clients with acute and chronic pathologies. Placements may include spas, special needs clinics, sports clinics, on-site business massage, and chiropractor and or physiotherapists offices. During these placements, the students will be guided and evaluated by the massage therapists.



Year 2

Course: Massage Therapy and Business

Duration: 40 Hours

In this course students will be introduced to fundamental concepts that are needed to start and operate a business successfully in a Canadian business environment. It is designed to develop an understanding of ongoing management and strategies for growth.

Course: Massage Therapy III

Duration: 80 Hours

During this course students will be provided with knowledge and skills to provide safe and effective treatments for various orthopaedic conditions.

Course: Systemic Anatomy II

Duration: 100 Hours

This is the final Systemic Anatomy course of the series. In this course, students will acquire knowledge of the reproductive and endocrine systems. These systems will be described in great detail and their relation to massage therapy. Importance and pathologies of these systems will be described in preparation for ACTP 002 and NAP 001 later in the year.

Course: Neuroanatomy and Physiology

Duration: 100 Hours

The peripheral nervous system is introduced beginning with spinal nerve anatomy and distribution. Major nerves of the cervical, brachial, lumbar, and sacral plexuses are studied with respect to their origins, pathway, innervations, and pathologies. This discussion will include the special sense as well as the anatomy of the eye and ear.

Secondly, student will be provided with an overview of the central nervous system (brain and spinal cord) including anatomy, physiology, and function. Segments on sensation and psychiatric disorders are explored. The ANS and its effects on the sympathetic and parasympathetic systems are explored in depth, with emphasis on its relation to massage.

Course: Therapeutic Exercises II

Duration: 60 Hours

This course will assist students in acquiring the fundamental knowledge and skills in integrating therapeutic exercise into massage therapy practice. Students will specifically learn foundational concepts and the applied science of exercise and techniques as therapeutic intervention. During the training the students will use different therapeutic techniques appropriate for different conditions.

Course: Clinical Laboratory II

Duration: 25 Hours

In this course, the student will have the opportunity to apply the knowledge and skills gained so far. In the 2nd level of practicum students is expected to perform an assessment on client and follow up with the appropriate treatment. The practice is done under supervision of massage instructor in a massage clinic setting.

Course: Nutrition

Duration: 25 Hours

In this course students will be introduced to fundamental concepts of carbohydrate, protein and fat metabolism. Student will learn various dietary requirements for some common and important health related conditions. They will also learn caloric values of different foods and concepts of balanced diet.

Course: Communication and Consent

Duration: 25 Hours

In this course students will learn the importance, modes and levels of communication, both with the clients and health care professionals. Also, students will be provided with detail explanation of purpose and process of informed consent.

Course: Pharmacology

Duration: 60 Hours

This Course has been designed to provide students with a basic and clear understanding of pharmacology, in relation to massage therapy. Student therapists will learn the importance of understanding drug interactions, contraindications and effects drugs will have on a massage treatment. Individual drug classes will be discussed in depths in order to provide students with valuable knowledge regarding pharmacology. Students will learn up to date drug information, but due to the Fields's constant growth, RMT's are encouraged to continue their education of the subject frequently upon graduation.

Course: Kinesiology

Hours: 25 Hours

Kinesiology is the study of movement. This course addresses anatomical, physiological and psychological mechanisms. Student will look at joint mechanics, strength and conditioning and gain a basic understanding of human movement.

Course: Orthopedic and Postural Assessment

Duration: 80 Hours

During this course, the student will learn how to complete a musculoskeletal assessment by applying the knowledge, skills and professional attitudes so far learned. The students will learn and perform different orthopedic tests to complete assessments including postural assessments.

Course: Clinical Pathology

Duration: 60 Hours

In this course, students will learn general and systemic pathology according to the Massage Therapy scope of practice. They will be examining major pathological conditions with reference to etiology, pathogenesis and clinical features.

Course: Treatment Plans: Assessments and Contraindications

Duration: 60 Hours

During this course students will be provided with knowledge and skills to assess motion range, balance control and contraindications to massage due to various acute or chronic conditions.



Course: Trigger Points and Specialized Massage

Duration: 50 Hours

During this course students will be provided with knowledge and skills to apply safe and effective massage treatments for trigger point therapy, lymphatic massage and pre-natal massage.

Course: Thermal and Hydrotherapy

Duration: 50 Hours

In this course students will learn the principles, techniques and application of thermal and hydrotherapy.

Course: **Career Planning**

Duration: 25 Hours

This course will assist students in acquiring the fundamental knowledge and skills to plan, prepare and successfully navigate the massage therapy job market.

Course: Integrated Studies

Duration: 60 Hours

This is a case study course and students will have the opportunity to explore low to high complexity cases drawn from the field. Each course will present multiple challenges related to communication, ethics, business, assessment and treatment. Students will be required to integrate and apply knowledge and skills gained from previous courses. Intensive training during this course will prepare students for final evaluation.

Course: Clinical Internship II

Duration: 180 Hours

In this course students will be placed in a clinic setting where they gain experience working on clients with acute and chronic pathologies. Placements may include spas, special needs clinics, sports clinics, on-site business massage, and chiropractor and or physiotherapists offices. During these placements, the students will be guided and evaluated by the massage therapists.



ETHOD OF EVALUATION OF MASSAGE THERAPY

Attendance and Participation:

As stated in the teaching methods, students are expected to regularly attend class and participate in practical classes. Attendance will be taken. Absence will be documented. While the quantity of your participation is important.

Grading Scale:

Marks (%)	Grade	Description
95 - 100	A ⁺	Excellent
90 - <95	A	Very good
85 - <90	B ⁺	Good
80 - <85	B	Satisfactory
70 - <80	C	Pass
< 70	F	Fail
Not attended	I	Incomplete